

Christine CAI

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RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Prosperity Now, Applied Research, remote (based in Philadelphia, PA)

Research Scientist

Jul 2023 – Oct 2025

- Conducted data analysis and visualization for applied research projects; wrote reports and blog posts.
- Mentored and managed junior coworkers; streamlined data workflows & pipelines.
- Designed and developed a novel methodology based on machine learning and small-area estimation methods to estimate local wealth disaggregated by race/ethnicity using SQL, Python, R and Stata.
- Translated complex methods and findings to non-technical audiences, including CEO & funders.

Amazon.com, Alexa Economics & Measurement, remote (based in Philadelphia, PA)

Economist Intern

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

- Extracted data using SQL; adjusted a Double Machine Learning (DML) model in Python; implemented matched difference-in-differences methods in Stata to validate and expand an existing production model.

Princeton University, Department of Economics, Princeton, NJ

Teaching Assistant

Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

- *Graduate Student Teaching Award* for ECO313 Econometric Applications (Spring 2021).
- Taught undergraduate econometrics and microeconomics; advised 18 junior theses (3 prize winners).

Research Assistant with Prof. Leah BOUSTAN

Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

University of Chicago, Booth School of Business, Chicago, IL

Research Professional

Jun 2016 – Jun 2018

- Wrote Stata code for the behind-the-scenes running of a randomized field experiment (RCT); cleaned and analyzed data; conducted literature reviews; supported presentations and paper (re)submissions.

SELECTED RESEARCH

- [White Flight from Asian Immigration: Evidence from California Public Schools](#) (with Leah BOUSTAN & Tammy TSENG), *Journal of Urban Economics: Insights* (2024).
- [Vertical Connections Matter: School Alumni Networks and Labor-Market Outcomes](#) (with Mahsa KHOSHNAMEA), *working paper*.
- [Tightening Immigration Policy: Unintended Consequences on Hispanic U.S. Citizens' Healthcare-Seeking Behavior and Health Status](#), *working paper*.

EDUCATION

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ

Ph.D., Economics (advisors: Prof. Leah BOUSTAN & Prof. Ilyana KUZIEMKO)

2023

M.A., Economics (fields: Labor Economics & Public Finance)

2020

University of Pennsylvania, Wharton School, Philadelphia, PA

Visiting Ph.D. Student in Economics, IvyPlus Exchange Scholar Program

2022–2023

Sciences Po, Paris, France

M.A., Economics & Public Policy, *Summa Cum Laude* (ranked 1st)

2015

- Recipient of the *Best Master Thesis in Economics* award, thesis advised by Prof. Quoc-Anh Do

B.A., Social Sciences, concentration in Economics, *Cum Laude* (top 10% in 2011-2012)

2013

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Expertise areas: Causal inference, applied microeconomics (labor, public, education, health).

Programming/software: Stata, Python, RStudio, SQL (Redshift, BigQuery), cloud environments (AWS, GCP),
L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office, Git.

Languages: French (native), Chinese dialect of Wenzhou (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced),
Mandarin Chinese (basics), Russian (beginner).